

Skill Arena - Phase 8 Document 2

Complete Maze Mechanics, Controls, Lives, Traps, Vision System, Checkpoints & Gameplay Rules Specification

Document Purpose

Define exactly how the Maze Game operates from the player's perspective.

Business Objective

Create a skill-based challenge that is easy to understand but difficult to master.

Core Philosophy

Player skill, decision making and consistency determine success.

Game Objective

Navigate from the maze entrance to the maze exit while overcoming obstacles and challenge mechanics.

Movement Controls

Keyboard, touch and future controller support. Movement validation remains server-authoritative.

Movement Rules

Players may move only through valid maze paths. Illegal movement is rejected server-side.

Maze Structure

Every maze contains a start point, end point, valid routes, dead ends and challenge elements.

Procedural Generation

Every challenge is generated dynamically by the Maze Intelligence Engine.

Difficulty Score

Every maze receives a difficulty score rather than a traditional level number.

PvP Challenge Rules

Both players receive the same generated maze. No timer is used. Winner is the first verified completion.

PvP Visibility Rules

Opponent movement remains hidden. Optional blurred progress indicators may be displayed.

House Challenge Rules

House challenges use timers, lives and enhanced challenge mechanics.

Lives System

Lives represent allowable mistakes during house challenges.

Life Loss Conditions

Traps, restricted zones, incorrect actions and future challenge mechanics may remove lives.

Challenge Failure

Challenge ends when lives reach zero or the timer expires.

Timer System

Used only for house challenges and selected future challenge categories.

Checkpoints

Future support for checkpoint systems on higher-complexity challenge types.

Vision Restriction System

Certain challenge categories may limit visible portions of the maze.

Fog of War

Future challenge types may reveal the maze progressively as players advance.

Trap System

Difficulty categories may introduce trap mechanics designed to increase decision complexity.

False Route System

Maze generator intentionally creates misleading routes and decision points.

Completion Verification

Challenge completion validated server-side before rewards or rankings update.

Replay Generation

Every challenge automatically generates replay records for future review.

Daily Calibration Maze

Each player receives a unique daily calibration challenge with no financial or ranking impact.

Calibration Scaling

Calibration difficulty scales according to player league, skill profile and progression.

Reward Eligibility

Rewards issued only after completion validation, replay generation and anti-cheat review.

Abandonment Rules

Disconnected players enter a paused state. Return windows and forfeiture rules apply.

Monitoring Requirements

Track completion times, failure rates, route efficiency and challenge health.

Acceptance Criteria

Maze gameplay remains fair, scalable, replayable and resistant to exploitation.